Drawing Scales Reference

Which scale to use, and what it is for. Metric scales as used across most of the world.

Common architectural scales

1:1 / 1:2 / 1:5	Full-size and construction details
1:10 / 1:20	Details, joinery, bathroom & kitchen layouts
1:50	Plans and sections of a single building / room layouts
1:100	General plans, sections and elevations of a building
1:200	Larger buildings, overall plans
1:500	Site plans, small masterplans
1:1000 / 1:1250	Location plans, urban context
1:2500 / 1:5000	Masterplans and large context

Reading a scale

At 1:50	20 mm on paper = 1000 mm real (1 m)
At 1:100	10 mm on paper = 1000 mm real (1 m)
At 1:200	5 mm on paper = 1000 mm real (1 m)

Tips

- [ ] Always put a scale bar on the drawing (survives resizing)
- [ ] State the scale AND the paper size (A1, A3...)
- [ ] Use a scale ruler, never guess

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